Summarise a Long Article or Video

One copy-and-paste prompt that turns pages of reading - or a long video transcript - into a short, clear summary you can actually revise from.



Notes by Shah Fahad

AI & Technology Innovator and Educator - Buner, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

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Use this note when: an article, lesson or video feels too long. In about two minutes you will get the main idea, the key points in order, and the difficult words explained - in simple English at your level.

The main prompt - copy, paste, fill the brackets

Open ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or any chat AI. Paste this prompt, replace the words in [brackets], then paste your article or transcript underneath it.

> You are my study helper. Summarise the text below for a student in [Class 8].
>
> Give me:
> 1. The main idea in one sentence.
> 2. A short summary in about [100] words, in simple English.
> 3. The 5 most important points, as bullet points, in the same order as the text.
> 4. Any difficult words, with a simple meaning for each one.
> 5. One question to test if I understood it.
>
> Use only the information in the text. Do not add facts from outside it. If something is not clear in the text, say so.
>
> Here is the text:
> [PASTE THE ARTICLE OR TRANSCRIPT HERE]

> **Why this prompt works:** it sets the level, the length and the shape of the answer, and it tells the AI to stay inside your text - so names, dates and numbers are not invented.

For an article - 3 easy steps

- **Copy the text.** Select the article text and copy it. If it is very long, summarise half at a time, then ask: "Now join these two summaries into one."
- **Paste and run.** Put the prompt first, the article after it.
- **Read and check.** Compare the key points with the original headings.

For a video - get the words first

- **YouTube:** open the video, tap the three dots under it, choose "Open transcript", copy the text, and paste it into the same prompt.
- **No transcript?** Watch in parts and summarise each part from your own short notes, or ask the AI to summarise a section you describe.
- **Long lectures:** summarise 10 minutes at a time, then combine the part-summaries into one final summary.

Make the summary fit you

Add one of these lines to the main prompt to change the result.

You want	Add this line
An even shorter version	"Now make it shorter - only 50 words, keeping the main idea."
Only the key points	"Give only bullet points, no paragraph."
Exam-style answer	"Write the summary as a neat exam answer of about 120 words."
Help in Urdu	"After the English summary, explain the main idea in simple Urdu."
One line to remember	"Finish with one line I can memorise."

Worked example

Long text (shortened here): a passage explaining that the sun heats water in seas and lakes, the water rises as vapour, cools and forms clouds, falls as rain, and collects again in rivers and seas - repeating in a cycle.

> **Summary you get:** The water cycle is the continuous movement of water between the Earth and the sky. The sun evaporates water, vapour forms clouds, rain falls, and the water collects and starts again. **Key points:** evaporation, condensation, precipitation, collection. **Difficult word:** evaporate - to turn from liquid into vapour.

Check it, and use it honestly

A summary is a shortcut to understanding, not a replacement for reading. Always check names, dates and numbers against the original - AI can make mistakes.

Use the summary to learn and revise. In tests, homework and your own writing, use your own words. Never paste private information - yours or anyone else's - into an AI tool.

Quick practice: take one long article from your textbook today, run this prompt, then close the AI and write the summary again from memory. If you can write it, you have learned it.